

INCIDENT INVESTIGATION REPORT

Title: Simulated Privilege Escalation Attack - Detection & Response Lab

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Tool Used: Splunk Enterprise (SIEM)

Classification: Lab Exercise

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY Three attack techniques were simulated on a Windows endpoint to test the SIEM detection capability. All three events were successfully detected in Splunk within minutes of execution using Windows Security Event Log monitoring.

2. ATTACK TECHNIQUES SIMULATED

- Created a rogue local user account (HackerTest) - maps to MITRE T1136.001
- Escalated account to the Administrators group - maps to MITRE T1098
- Created a persistent scheduled task (WindowsUpdateHelper) - maps to MITRE T1053.005

3. SPLUNK DETECTIONS

- EventCode 4732 detected - Member added to Administrators group
- EventCode 4720 detected - New user account created
- Timestamp: 2026-04-20 02:00 - all events logged precisely

4. RISK RATING: High - unauthorized admin account creation is a critical indicator of compromise

5. REMEDIATION ACTIONS TAKEN

- Rogue user account deleted
- Scheduled task removed
- Recommended: Alert rule created for EventCode 4720 and 4732 in production environments